

ECON 4050 Final Project Presentation

Guidelines and Expectations Dr. Soliman | Clemson University

Purpose. The presentation is an opportunity to explain the main question, data, empirical approach, and findings from your final project in a concise format. A strong presentation does not need to include every detail from the paper. It should clearly communicate what you studied, how you studied it, what you found, and what limitations remain.

1. Format and Timing

- Each student will give a 7-minute presentation of their final project.
- As stated in the syllabus, presentations will be followed by up to 3 minutes of Q&A.
- Plan for approximately 6-8 slides. More slides are allowed, but only if they can be presented clearly within the time limit.
- The presentation should be based on your own final project analysis, not a general overview of the topic.

2. Required Content

Your presentation must include the following components.

Component	Requirement
Motivation	Explain why the topic matters and why the question is economically or socially relevant.
Research question	State the question clearly and identify whether the project is correlational or causal.
Data	Describe the data source, unit of observation, sample, key variables, and any important restrictions.
Descriptive figure from R	Include at least one descriptive figure generated in R, with readable labels and a clear takeaway.
Regression output from R	Include at least one regression table or regression output generated from R. Interpret the main coefficient in words.
Interpretation and limitations	Explain what your results mean and what they do not show. Be explicit about correlation versus causation and relevant limitations.

A strong presentation gives the audience a reason to care before showing regression results. It also explains the unit of observation, uses readable figures and tables, and interprets the main coefficient rather than only reporting it.

3. Recommended Slide Structure

You may organize the presentation differently, but the following structure is a useful template for a 7-minute presentation.

Slide(s)	Content	Approximate time
1	Title, topic, and research question	30 seconds
2	Motivation and background	1 minute
3	Data and key variables	1 minute
4	Descriptive figure or summary statistics	1 minute
5	Empirical strategy or estimating equation	1 minute
6	Main regression result	1-1.5 minutes
7	Interpretation, limitations, and conclusion	1-1.5 minutes

4. Guidance by Project Path

Path A: Correlational project

- State clearly that the estimates describe associations, not necessarily causal effects.
- Explain the main sources of bias that may prevent a causal interpretation, such as omitted variables, selection, or reverse causality.
- Use the Q&A to show that you understand what additional design or data would be needed to estimate a causal effect.

Path B: Causal project

- State the treatment, comparison group, outcome, and source of identifying variation.
- Explain the identifying assumption in plain language.
- Discuss at least one reason the identifying assumption could fail in your setting.

5. Example Presentation

Example deck. The final project folder includes a past student presentation on minimum wage and unemployment. Use it as an example of effective organization, clear slide titles, readable tables, and a concise progression from motivation to data, empirical strategy, results, limitations, and conclusion.

Important clarification. The example should be treated as a model for presentation style and structure, not as a template that overrides the current course requirements.

6. Presentation Advice

- Put the main takeaway of each slide in the title or first line.
- Use large fonts and avoid dense paragraphs. Slides should support your explanation rather than reproduce the paper.
- Do not show raw R console output unless it is formatted and readable. A clean regression table is preferred.
- When presenting a coefficient, interpret the unit. For example: “A one-unit increase in X is associated with a Y-unit change in the outcome.”
- Practice the presentation aloud. Seven minutes is short, so prioritize the research question, data, main result, and limitations.
- Anticipate questions about data sources, variable definitions, causality, and robustness.

7. Q&A Expectations

During Q&A, you may be asked to clarify your data, explain a coefficient, justify a modeling choice, or discuss the limitations of your design. A good answer does not require pretending the project is perfect. It requires showing that you understand the empirical tradeoffs and can interpret your results carefully.

8. Final Checklist

- The presentation is timed to 7 minutes.
- The research question is stated clearly.
- The presentation identifies whether the project is correlational or causal.
- The data source, sample, and unit of observation are explained.
- At least one descriptive figure generated in R is included.
- At least one regression output or table generated from R is included.
- The main coefficient is interpreted in words.
- The limitations are specific to the project.
- Slides are readable and not overloaded with text.